



PSYCHOLOGY

Stage 3

WACE Examination 2010

Final Marking Key

This 'stand alone' version of the WACE Examination 2010 Final Marking Key is provided on an interim basis.

The Standards Guide for this examination will include the examination questions, marking key, question statistics and annotated candidate responses. When the Standards Guide is published, this document will be removed from the website.

Section One: Research methods

20% (20 Marks)

Question 1 (a) Name **one** type of subjective quantitative measure used by psychologists to collect research data.

Description	Marks
One of the answers below may be used. • Checklists • Rating scales • Likert scales • questionnaire No marks for describing a measure. No mark for 'scale'.	1
Total marks	1

Question 1 (b) Describe the steps a psychologist would follow to collect data with the measure named in Question 1(a).

Description	Marks
One mark each • The psychologist must develop/source an appropriate scale. (1) • The psychologist gives the measure to the person/individual to complete or fill in. (1) • The psychologist marks/scores/collates the answers/responses to give a numerical value. (1) 1 mark each for any two steps.	1–2
Total marks	2

Question 1 (c) (i) Describe **two** physiological measures that are used to study different states of consciousness.

Description	Marks
One mark each for any two of the answers below may be used. • Electrical activity of the brain/EEG involves placing electrodes on head and brain waves are measured to determine frequency and amplitude of brain waves. (1) • Heart rate is measured by a monitor that records the heart beat or pulse rate directly. (1) • Body temperature may be measured through the skin such as the ear, throat or finger.(1) • Galvanic skin response involves placing electrodes on hair free parts of the body to measure electrical conductivity of skin. (1) • No marks for naming a measure without description.	1–2
Total marks	2

Question 1 (c) (ii) Explain why physiological measures are an important way of collecting data when studying different states of consciousness.

Description	Marks
Two marks for any one of the answers below. - Consciousness is a hypothetical construct so it can't be measured directly unlike height or weight. (2) - Observed behaviour doesn't necessarily explain the state of physical consciousness, you can only make inferences about states of consciousness from behaviour. (2) - Physiological measures provide information about levels of arousal in the body which allow inferences to be drawn about the different states of consciousness. (2)	1–2
One mark for a less detailed answer	
Total marks	2

Question 2 (a) (i) Identify the independent variable/s for this study.

Description	Marks
Whether the carers had used respite care or not	1
Total marks	1

Question 2 (a) (ii) Identify the dependent variable/s for this study.

Description	Marks
Measures of depression, anxiety and stress/adjustment	1
Total marks	1

Question 2 (b) State the conclusion that the researchers could draw from the results.

Description	Marks
One mark for any one of the answers below. There were no differences in depression, anxiety or stress in: - carers who had used respite compared to those who had not used respite - carers who had and had not used respite care had the same average level of stress/adjustment - With a $p > 0.05$ the means scores are likely due to chance factors rather than a real difference in mean scores. The results are not statistically significant.	1
Total marks	1

Question 2 (c) (i) Explain **one** limitation of the study that affects the generalisations that can be made on the basis of the results.

Description	Marks
Two marks for any one of the answers below. - The participants were not randomly assigned to groups or the researchers did not control for any possible differences between the groups. or It is not an experimental design therefore you cannot tell whether using/not using respite care causes stress/adjustment difficulties. (2) - The number of participants in the two groups was not the same. or There were a lot more carers who had not used respite than those who had used respite, or the number of participants was small. (2) - We do not know what experiences the participants might have had between	2

Time 1 and Time 2 that might have affected their depression, anxiety and stress levels. (2) • Non-representative sample/volunteers are not necessarily representative of the population. • The study has not incorporated the use of any objective measures.	
One mark for a less detailed answer.	1
Total marks	2

Question 2 (c) (ii) Suggest **one** way that the researchers could improve the research design to deal with the limitation described in Question 2 (c) (i).

Description	Marks
Two marks for any one of the answers below. • Conduct an experimental study where you randomly assign carers to 'respite care' and 'no respite care' groups and measure their stress/adjustment before and after. • Make sure that you recruit an equal number of carers who had used respite care and had not used respite care. • Measure any stressful life experiences that the participants have had between Time 1 and Time 2 • Increase sample size to make it more representative • Stress could also be measured by means of cortisol levels	2
One mark for a less detailed answer	1
Total marks	2

Question 3 (a) State the major advantage of this kind of study.

Description	Marks
One of the answers below may be used: • Researchers do not have to be concerned about the cohort effects. • Researchers can study ways in which early development can affect later development. • Researchers assess age changes rather than just age differences. • Differences among individuals as well as changes within individuals over time can be assessed. • Researchers can see the development of children over time.	1
Total marks	1

Question 3 (b) Identify **one** disadvantage of this kind of study.

Description	Marks
One of the answers below may be used: • It is expensive. • It takes a long time to get results. • Participants may drop out along the way because they withdraw, move, and cannot be traced. • Practice effects due to repeated testing, may affect results. • Findings may not be applicable to the next generation/another cohort.	1
Total marks	1

Question 3 (c) Identify **two** ethical issues that are associated with this type of study and state how psychologists deal with these in their research.

Description	Marks
Any two of the answers below may be used. • Voluntary Participation (1) – potential participants must be completely free to choose whether or not to take part in the study: participants must not be pressured or offered undue incentives to take part in the study. (1) • Informed consent/children as participants (1) – parents have to be told exactly what participating in the study will involve and they must provide written consent on behalf of themselves and their child. (1) • Right to withdraw participants (1) – must be free to withdraw from the study at any time without any negative consequences. (1) • Duty of care (1) – if the research find that families or individual are experiencing mental health problems or other serious difficulties, they must provide feedback to them and give them details of where they might be able to access help. (1) • Beneficence (1) – ensure the participants are not harmed in any way/ and the benefits of the research outweigh the risk / must have positive benefits to the community. (1) • Confidentiality (1) – any information or data belonging to participants will remain private, in a secure place and not be released to a third party without the written consent of the participant. (1)	1–4
Total marks	4

Section Two: Short answer

50% (50 Marks)

Question 4 (a) Name **two** of the four stages in Piaget's theory of cognitive development.

Description	Marks
Any two of the answers below may be used. One mark for each answer: • Sensorimotor • Preoperational • Concrete operational • Formal operational.	1–2
Total marks	2

Question 4 (b) Some researchers have criticised the tasks Piaget used with children to develop his theory of cognitive development. Outline **two** of these criticisms. (4 marks)

Description	Marks
Two marks each for any two of the answers: • Tasks are not realistic/not familiar to children/outside children's everyday experiences (1) so you're not really assessing what they think they are assessing, therefore it is not a valid measure. (1) • Tasks rely on verbal expression of understanding (1) and so can underestimate competence in children who have difficulties expressing themselves. (1) • Tasks that involve an adult repeatedly asking children the same question (1) might put pressure on children to change their answer (1) or children might wonder why they are being asked the same question again if the answer hasn't changed, (1) so might give answers that underestimate their competence due to social pressure. (1) • Tasks do not take into consideration social interaction (1) that is an important part of children's learning/world. (1) Notes: Students may give responses related to criticisms of the theory rather than the task. Marks are not awarded for these responses, e.g. • Piaget failed to account for the role of culture in development • the age at which children attain particular stages often varies considerably and is task dependent • Piaget's theory assumes that a child is at one stage or another. It does not take into account the issue that cognitive development may progress at different rates depending on the area of concern. • Piaget stressed rational thinking and didn't account that people's thinking could be biased, irrational and emotional.	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 4 (c) Explain **two** contributions Piaget's theory has made to our understanding of children's cognitive development.

Description	Marks
Any of two of the answers below may be used. These are one mark answers. Two marks for a more elaborated response.	
Piaget has contributed the following understandings about children's cognitive development: • Children's cognitive development progresses through a series of ordered stages. • Children develop from concrete to abstract thinking and reasoning. • Children construct their understanding of the world through their interaction with the environment. • Children construct their understanding of the world through the internal cognitive processes of assimilation and accommodation. • As children develop, they become less egocentric, • As children develop they are more able to think symbolically and reason abstractly.	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 5 (a) How do psychologists define 'personality'?

Description	Marks
One mark each for any of the following: • Individual characteristic ways of thinking, feeling and acting/behaving. (1) • Individual psychological characteristics that make a person distinct from others/distinguishes us from others. (1) • Leads us to act consistently / predictably / and in an enduring way/ expressed in different circumstances/across situations. (1)	1–2
Total marks	2

Question 5 (b) Identify the main concepts of 'trait' theories of personality.

Description	Marks
One mark for any of the answers below: • Personality traits are stable and enduring • Personality traits predict behaviour • Our biological makeup plays a major role in determining our personality • Trait theories look for differences between people • Traits can be identified, described and measured • Traits are emotional, cognitive and behavioural tendencies • The number of traits necessary to describe personality is open to debate. For example the Five Factor Model presents personality as having five factors.	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 5 (c) Describe **two** criticisms of humanistic theories of personality.

Description	Marks
Any two of the answers below may be used. Humanistic theories of personality are: - theories are based on clinical observation or case studies (1) rather than empirical research. (1) - theories are hard to test scientifically. (1) The importance of individual experience makes it too difficult to objectively study. (1) - the theory is too simplistic/naïve. (1) The fundamental belief that humans are inherently/basicly good is too optimistic. It fails to consider the negative side of humans. (1) - the theory of self-actualisation is lacking integrated, clearly defined theoretical underpinnings. (1) The theory is biased toward individualistic values. (1)	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 6 (a) Name **two** types of adolescent peer groups that have been observed by researchers.

Description	Marks
Any two of the answers below may be used. One mark for each. - Cliques - Dyads - Crowds	1–2
Total marks	2

Question 6 (b) Research with adolescents has identified five stages in the development of peer relationships. Describe **two** of these stages

Description	Marks
1 mark for identifying the stage, one mark for any one description following the stage. - Stage 1: Cliques or pre-crowd stage (1) small groups of adolescents that usually interact with each other/ usually the same sex/ each is isolated from the other cliques (1) - Stage 2: Crowds (1): the cliques interact with each other, you need to belong to a clique to become part of the crowd, activities mostly at weekends when group meets. (1) - Stage 3: Changes in the structure of the crowd: (1) the higher ranking clique members for heterosexual cliques, dating begins, older teenagers. (1) - Stage 4: Fully developed crowd (1), composed of various types of couples with close associations (1) - Stage 5: Couples have begun to go their separate ways (1) older teenagers. (1)	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 6 (c) Explain, from a psychological perspective, how peer relationship development influences psychological development.

Description	Marks
Any four of the answers below may be used. - Provides a supportive group for trying out new behaviours - Peers model alternative beliefs and values in shaping their own psychological development - Gives a person confidence to try something new, build resilience to overcome setbacks and stay positive and so, develop self-esteem and self worth. - Helps build self-efficacy whereby individuals can take on challenges and approach threatening situations with more confidence. - Provides social validation of emerging identity through allowing a person to experiment and explore to develop a sense of self, an emotional awareness of who they are. - Provides a source of other types of activities that have an impact on social identity development - Group membership - identity.	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 7 (a) State **two** reasons why psychologists are interested in studying the relationship between culture and behaviour.

Description	Marks
One mark for each answer. Any of the answers below may be used: - To develop understandings of accepted norms in culture - To find out whether there are differences in behaviour between people of different cultures - To find out whether there are similarities in behaviour between people of different cultures - Adds to our understanding of societal/cultural influences on behaviour - To find out how much of our development, learning and behaviour in general is shaped by our behaviour.	1–2
Total marks	2

Question 7 (b) Describe **two** ways in which psychology contributes to the understanding of mental health issues in the community.

Description	Marks
Two marks each for any two of the answers below: - research investigates the causes and consequences of poor mental health (2) - develops and delivers programs that can assist in the prevention of mental health problems and treating of mental health problems / seek social justice (2) - reduces stigma associated to mental illness (2) - promotes the use of and increases in knowledge about available health services. (2) - develops awareness by describing and understanding notions of 'normal' and what is acceptable and unacceptable.	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 7 (c) When conducting research with people from different cultures, psychologists need to consider values and ethical guidelines. Describe **two** such issues that need to be considered.

Description	Marks
One mark each for any two issues named. One mark each for two related descriptions: • Language and Communication (1) - Set up interpreters/ find out about specific guidelines for working with people from that culture/ discuss research with the community leaders/ obtain consent from individuals, parents, guardian, family. (1) • Cultural recognition of cultural beliefs, values and practices (1) obtain consent from the individuals to be interviewed in a culturally appropriate way/set up formal documents in native language as well as English. (1) • Minority group issue related to vulnerability and status, disempowerment (1) issues of gender, age/ advocacy toward group/ sensitivity to participants. (1) • Benefits of the research being studied to the cultural group (1) relevance of project, benefits to specific groups, transfer to other groups within and outside specific communities. (1)	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 8 (a) Define 'social structure'

Description	Marks
• Relationships within and between individuals, groups and systems/institutions in society. or • Social class or hierarchy system in society	2
Less detailed answer worth one mark	1
Total marks	2

Question 8 (b). Describe **two** ways in which technology has influenced social structure in contemporary society. Give an example of each.

Description	Marks
One mark for each of two examples. One mark each for two descriptions. One mark for any of the answers below may be used • Communication, Medical and Transport are examples of technology that may be used with a detailed explanation for two marks. • Less detailed answer worth one mark. For example: • technology to communicate rather than face to face communication, e.g. avatars, cyber relationships • Improved communication eg. relationships can develop with people from all over the world, 24 hours a day.eg. online dating, relationships • communication used to express and develop social identities.	1–4
Total marks	4

Question 8 (c) Explain what is meant by the 'interdependence of theoretical perspectives' in psychology. Provide an example to support your answer.

Description	Marks
Three marks for the explanation and one mark for the example. The answers below are provided as suggestions. Any of the answers below may be used in conjunction with a relevant example: • All areas of psychology are inter-related/related to each other. • To fully understand things in psychology we need to look from different perspectives; self, others and society. • Research in psychology can benefit from taking multiple perspectives on an issue/involving collaboration with people from other disciplines/professions (e.g., psychoneuroimmunology, applied linguistics). • Change in one area usually means consequences for other areas. • Theoretical perspectives are based on research from different areas/built up over time. • Any intervention needs to be well researched, its impact considered and preparation for unintended consequences.	1–4
Total marks	4

Section Three: Extended answer

30% (40 Marks)

Note 1: The following marking guide is generic and suitable for both questions in Section Three.

GUIDE TO MARKING RESPONSES	MARKS
Evidence used to support statements, lines of argument	/8
Makes reference to relevant psychological studies, theories and research with explicit explanation of what the studies or theory contribute to the topic being discussed. Explanations are accurate (1). Explanations contain some inaccuracies (1).	7–8
Makes reference to relevant psychological studies, theories and research (1) and describes three or more relevant psychological studies, theories and research (1).	5–6
Anecdotal examples are used to illustrate generalisations and statements that are consistent with current psychological understandings.	4
The response contains mostly generalisations and statements consistent with current psychological understandings but without any supporting evidence.	3
The response contains some generalisations and statements consistent with current psychological understandings but without any supporting evidence.	2
The response is mainly a series of personal generalisations.	1
Response has no relevance to the question.	0
Complexity of discussion/argument	/8
Displays a high level of sophistication in the construction, development and depth of a logical argumentative discussion and analysis (1). Demonstrates an understanding of the complexity of human behaviour (1) and explicitly discusses how factors related to self, others and/or society may interact (1) to influence the relevant behaviour.	6–8
Displays a sustained logical argument throughout the discussion that demonstrates some understanding of how factors related to self (1), others (1) and society (1) influence the relevant behaviour.	3–5
A simple narrative showing some basic psychological understanding of the topic (1) with minimal (1) or no evidence of sustained logical argument and evaluation.	1–2
Discussion/argument suggests minimal understanding of the factors that influence the relevant behaviour.	0
Communication skills	/4
A sophisticated, well-written and well-constructed argument using appropriate language of psychology. Sound use of the conventions except where expression is enhanced by defying conventions.	4
Accurate and relevant use of a range psychological terms.	3
Literacy enables the construction of a meaningful response but shows minimal use of accurate and relevant psychological terms.	2
Poor literacy skills may interfere with the ability of the marker to understand the response (as evidenced by very poor spelling, grammar, failure to use capital letters correctly and poor sentence and paragraph structure).	1
Response is mainly unable to be understood by the marker.	0
TOTAL	/20

Question 9**(20 marks)**

Construct an argument, with supporting empirical evidence, to explain how individual development, communication style and social values and practices influence the interaction between generations.

In constructing your argument you should:

- give a clear definition of the interaction between generations
- explain how individual development influences the interaction between generations
- explain how communication style influences the 'interaction between generations
- explain how social values and practices influence the interaction between generations
- consider how these influences affect interaction between generations
- finish with a conclusion.

Marks will be awarded for referring to empirical evidence in your answer.

Candidates are not expected to have detailed knowledge specific to generation X and Y. Candidates' responses will reflect content of the Stage 3 syllabus used to explain how these factors influence interaction between generations. Students do not need to have studied the generation gap as a concept in order to do this. The generic marking guide can be used to mark student responses.

Definitions

Interaction between generations relates to the differences between people from a younger generation, and people from an older generation. It involves interactions between parents and children or whole generations and is often referred to as the generation gap. Generations are viewed in the following way. Baby boomers include the generation born between 1945 and 1964, X generation is 1965–1984 and Y generation is 1985–2004.

There was a large population increase after the second world-war which saw young people have a greater voice. Differences between generations exist in a broad range of areas including technology, politics, workplace behaviour, age of consent, age of responsibility and education. Rapid development in areas such as technology has meant rapid change in the social structure of society. In recent years this change has seen greater than normal differences in interaction between the generations.

There appears to be a generational gap often reinforced by the media whereas research has in fact shown the gap to be not as big as previously thought. An example of this may be seen in parent/child relationships. Studies show that children from the X and Y generation along with the parents in the baby boomer generation get on better than the baby boomers did with their parents. However, other research suggests that members of the baby boomers and the X generation are worried about several issues such as the behaviour of the younger generations. The following points illustrate some of the psychological understandings related to individual development, communication style and social values in practices between generations.

Individual development

- **Personality Theory:** Research states Generation X tends to be more independent, self motivated and self sufficient, individualistic, autonomous and has less need for leadership. On the other hand, baby boomers are more diligent workers and prefer a stable working environment.
- **Humanistic learning theory:** Maslow's hierarchy of needs theory asserts that people move through a series of motives progressing from basic biological needs to self esteem needs in order to achieve self-actualisation. Research states baby boomers have generally adapted to this theory and that they work towards achieving self-actualisation. Maslow notes that very few people ever reach this stage. Generation X

however, do not seem to fit the Maslow model. They want to gain gratification at more than one level at the same time. They prefer to mesh at least two levels together. For example, the basic needs level is combined with their need for self-achievement. This is supported for example in research saying they are less devoted to their jobs and happy to work on other motives in Maslow's hierarchy including esteem needs.

- Social learning theory: Bandura's social cognitive theory claims that observational learning plays a role in personality development and behaviour, and that through self-regulation we learn to take responsibility for our own behaviour. Researchers debate the issue that while baby boomers generally self regulate behaviour, the younger generations are less willing to take responsibility for their behaviour. Perhaps this is because of greater government regulation that has removed some of the choice for individuals. Other research by social psychologists, try to explain behaviour through traits or personality types. Individuals are not growing up to be the same as their parents as their own parents may have. As technology develops and creates change in the structure of society, each generation is learning to adapt to the ongoing changes. This change began with the baby boomers. On another issue, understandably, people like to be with others of their age. Perhaps cognitive dissonance may be part of this. You could say this is one reason why members of a generation feel more comfortable with people of the same age. They like consistency and being with those who have the same views.

Communication style and the generation gap

- Developmental theory Piaget: Younger generations through their teenage years are developing higher cognitive abilities such as abstract and reasoning skills. They want to be more autonomous. Hence conflicts appear between parents and children or younger and older generations although this is normal behaviour across all generations. Conflicts between parents and children vary although current research asserts that today this conflict doesn't damage the long-term relationship between parent and child. In fact, children in their twenties are staying home longer or returning home to be with parents for many reasons some of which include financial or relationship issues.
- Behaviour and Peer Influence: Dunphy's, 1960's study has shown the younger generation develops more independence through progressive group relationships including dyads, cliques and crowds. Members find their identity and gradually become better communicators with older people in society as well as family members. There are less serious arguments between parents and teenagers. In fact many younger people are spending more time with their parents. Traditionally, baby boomers left home as soon as they could.
- Language: each generation develops and speaks a different language. Their language includes verbal and non-verbal communication such as emailing, texting or formal writing. Studies show great examples of miscommunication between generations who don't understand the 'language'. Interestingly, because of computer technology such as facebook and texting, studies are showing the language difference is not as wide as for previous generations. This is an example of interdependence between generations, where one generation can teach another such as text messaging. This has brought generations closer together especially with regard to safety and communication.
- Mentoring relationships have adjusted to needs of workers, or individuals in specific areas. For example, younger people educate older people with regard to using forms of technology and sharing ideas, while older more experienced, people impart leadership skills, competencies and behaviours to younger people. This can be rewarding if both sides want to exchange information.

- Expressing feelings – Research states baby boomers were taught to keep feelings to themselves, Generation X and Y are more open about their feelings. This has influenced how generation X are teaching their children. Generation Y children have a greater say in family matters. This differs greatly to baby boomer thinking. They were brought up in an era where children had a clear role of simply being children and adults made the decisions.

Social values and practices and the generation gap

- The values issue is not one so much as between generations, rather it is across generations. Values such as self-respect, respect for others, moral values and work ethic are issues that have created conflict between generations. Those from the same generation tend to share the same values, ideas, communication styles and outlooks and expectations. Differences cause misunderstandings and tensions arise and result in negative interaction. Work practices differ significantly between the generations.
- Research has shown Generation X is more independent perhaps because parents were working. Their values are job achievement, ambition and loyalty to the profession and personal satisfaction. A balance between home and work is important. Job satisfaction is more important than promotion. Don't owe anyone anything. Baby boomers grew up in a period of great stability and economic growth. Their values included hard work and loyalty to employers although this has changed more to quality of life and loyalty to workers. Many don't like change and are not technology savvy. However money and recognition are more important to the baby boomers than the younger generations.
- Cultures and their generations will vary their values both within the cultures and between different cultures in areas such as respecting authority, patterns of decision-making and leadership styles. How people get on depends on response to change and work patterns and ethics. Cultural differences are evident in baby boomers who have moved to another country and then had children. The gap here can be larger than for mainstream families.
- Marriage and children – Baby boomers were brought up in family oriented environment where having children was an accepted part of life. Studies show that generation X has a different view: For many, children are not seen as a priority, rather, their relationship comes first, marriage is less of a priority, couples often don't live together as one partner works away, divorce is a less complicated process, median age for having children has risen, life expectancy higher, higher standard of living.

Explanation of how individual development, communication style and social values and practices influence the generation gap.

- Important longitudinal studies on children growing are providing valuable information on generational issues of communication, individual development and values. Research such as *Growing up in Australia* and the Stanley, Richardson and Prior, 2004 study analyse data that will enable interventions and prevention strategies to be developed for better relations between individuals, communities and cultures within the generations.
- It is important to realise that while values have changed, we each need to make an effort as individuals, community members and a society that work together, interdependent of each other. Through being informed and knowledgeable of the wants and needs of each generation we can continue to reduce the gap between the generations. An example in this situation is the research on grandparenting and the contact between grandchildren. Many are taking responsibility for their grandchildren and narrowing the 'gap' as they become closer to understanding each other.

- Psychology can play a role here by researching the interdependent role between self, others and society within generations as they learn to adapt to a constantly changing world. Generations need to understand the journey that each will pass through from being the young generation to the old generation and the role that each can play in building a positive intergenerational society.

Conclusion

Therefore, while there are differences between generations, those differences do not appear to be as great as those from each previous generation. Less conflict occurs between older children or young adults and parents, especially as children are remaining home for longer periods.

Not every member of a generation will share characteristics in common with other members of their generation, however most will. Knowing generational trends will enable each to resolve or compromise on issues otherwise misunderstood. For example, laziness versus a work/life balance.

Psychologists can work towards this challenge to provide empirical research into improving the communication between future generations.

Question 10

'The media are to blame for the existence of stereotypes in society.'

Evaluate the accuracy of this statement with reference to psychological understandings related to self, others and society.

In your response:

- begin with a broad evaluation of the statement, including definitions of any terms that you consider are necessary,
- include information related to self, others and society,
- show how these psychological understandings interact,
- finish with your conclusion.

Marks will be awarded for referring to empirical evidence in your paper. (20 marks)

The following may provide some useful background information but contains minimal references to psychological terms, studies and research and does not satisfactorily represent the kind of response that would be desirable from students. The generic marking guide is used to mark student responses.

In general, "media" refers to various means of communication. For example, television, radio, internet and the newspaper are different types of media. Media stereotypes are inevitable, especially in the advertising, entertainment and news industries, which need as wide an audience as possible to quickly understand information. Stereotypes act like codes that give audiences a quick, common understanding of a person or group of people—usually relating to their class, ethnicity or race, gender, sexual orientation, social role or occupation. We tend to categorise people to put some order into the bombardment of information from the media.

Stereotypes are fixed general image, characteristic, etc. that a lot of people believe to represent a particular type of person or thing:

- racial, e.g. Aboriginals are seen as second class citizens (society)
- gender, e.g. women are bad drivers , blondes are dumb (self)

- age, e.g. old people are said to be very forgetful or cranky or young people are lazy and take drugs. Both young and old are subject to the notion of their having been socially constructed.(self)
- religion, e.g. Catholics families have a lot of children, (society)
- profession, e.g. all lawyers are greedy (other)
- other...such as social class-upper classes are smarter, working class are not as smart.

Psychologically, we need to stereotype because experience teaches us to build up predicted patterns of behaviour. For example, We 'know' that blind people can't see and need a guide dog or cane.

The media uses stereotypes because in a small period of time they have to get a great deal of information across to you about a person or situation, stereotyping do this. The problem is that there may or may not be an element of truth in a stereotype. Some people may fit into the stereotypes identified, there are many who do not. Stereotypes linked to groups of people can limit their behaviours and actions. Good quality programmes and drama will attempt to break stereotypes.

Stereotypes can be positive and present an image that is very favourable for certain groups of people: e.g doctors on TV shows are usually good looking, smart and noble

Stereotypes can be negative so that one primary image is offered and it brings with it a whole series of assumptions about a character. A physical or cultural attribute is a code for a whole series of critical assumptions, e.g. fatness is often code for jolly, funny, greedy, lazy

The danger of a stereotype is that people build a view of others and then behave as though the stereotype is real.

This can impact on:

- career choices
- personal image-acceptance of self
- life choices
- relationships with family, friends and partners
- study options
- other.

For example, a boy may not consider nursing as a career as the stereotype nurse is an attractive female.

Media examples may include films like **Bend it like Beckham** stereotypes that are portrayed in the film:

- girls don't play soccer, soccer is for boys only
- girls should be wanting to get married and have children
- boys should be playing soccer not coaching a female soccer team
- girls belong in the kitchen cooking Punjabi.

Perhaps the media isn't solely to blame for developing stereotypes but it is to blame for sustaining them. They keep reporting using reference to the stereotype which might otherwise have vanished.

Self

- Models used in the media are often pictured as unreasonably skinny, and the airbrushing techniques make these women look impossibly perfect. Sometimes, a model pictured in an advertisement isn't even a real woman, but a composite of the body parts of several. This distortion of the female body has led celebrities to take up the cause of "the size zero." There are too many young girls idealizing over being a certain size and too many representations of "too skinny" stars in today's media harshly affect the body image of young women and girls in the real world.

Other SELF examples may include:

- media's portrayal of the factors that affect behaviour such as the use of drugs, exercise.
- media's portrayal of people with ADHD
- media's portrayal of responses to life changes-the effect on personality.

Others

Gay stereotyping, makes the homosexual community look like they are promiscuous and morally questionable, which often leads to the terrible bigotry. The media has been responsible (perhaps) for implying that all gay people will/should die of AIDS. Gay stereotypes in the media are extremely detrimental to the progress of the homosexual community's fight for equal rights, e.g. the media's portrayal of gay marriages, media time given to bigots and ultra religious antagonists. The media, however, can also educate the public by breaking down social categorisation of people. For example, more people are accepting of the gay community and those with disabilities. Other examples may include:

- media's portrayal of the behaviour in groups-soccer violence, mob mentality
- media's representation of different relationships such as gay marriages, the break down of the family unit
- media's use of persuasive communication aimed at target audiences. Drink coke to be popular.

Society

One of the most dangerous ways in which the media stereotypes people is through the use of racial stereotypes. This impression that people of color are somehow more violent, leads to fear and ignorance that fuels racism in society.

The perceived danger of minorities is then carried over into the news. It is not uncommon to see far more images of black or non Australian criminals than of white criminals, even when stories are being presented about all of them.... Examples may include news article comments such as -One of the most famous examples of media injustice towards minorities comes from the coverage of Hurricane Katrina, where black teenagers taking food from a flooded store were described as looters. A white teen doing the exact same thing was described as a victim trying to survive.

The media portray terrorists as wearing a head scarf as if it is a terrorist uniform. People interpret anyone wearing head scarves are terrorists. Some media personalities who have developed high social status may encourage people to develop stereotyping of groups or individuals. For example, a person may call the boat people 'queue jumpers'.

Other SOCIETY examples may include:

- media's portrayal of different cultures morals and values as compared to our own
- media's portrayal of different cultures acceptance of disability or mental health issues.
- changes with technology – WWW, youtube, etc., all new forms of 'media'.

In conclusion, it is impossible to deny that media stereotypes are everywhere. It is important to develop understandings such as:

- humans will always stereotype as it is a part of the cognitive process, of making sense of the world.
- recognise stereotypes which are both positive and negative
- consider the accumulated impact of the stereotypes
- recognise other forms of stereotyping.
- The media can play a positive and a negative role in stereotyping people in society.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Section One

Question 2

Jardin, C., & Pakenham, K. (2010). Carers of adults with mental illness: comparison of respite users and non-users. *Australian Psychologist* 45(1), pp. 50–58.